

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

For me, that thing is budgeting. It acts as the central hub of all of your financial activity, empowers you to make decisions and incites more thoughtful behaviour around money. And, like a gym membership or yoga pass, if your budget is left to languish in a notebook or Google drive somewhere, its magical powers stop working, and it becomes yet another thing to feel guilty about. This is why our rituals and routines around money are so important.

Coping when things don't go right

Your money habits and rituals are there as a safety net – they are designed to be the constant fixture that helps you to stay on track even when life gets really busy, or throws you curveballs. However, as we've discussed, even acts of self-care take effort to keep up, and even fully established habits require upkeep. We also know that, inevitably, when we're short on time or energy, it's often the things that we do to look after ourselves rather than other people that tend to fall off a cliff. It's amazing how quickly even the healthiest of rituals – even the ones where you can actively feel them making a difference in your life – can start to unravel if your priorities shift just a little. We tell ourselves that we can skip a check-in or two, that we'll update our budget when we have time, and before we know it it's been a few weeks and we're starting to feel rusty or out of control.